

CHURCH CLERK

Role Definition, Terms of Reference (TORs) & Operating Manual

Seventh-day Adventist Church

1. Purpose of This Document

This document helps a Church Clerk understand, organize, and faithfully execute the responsibilities of the office according to the Church Manual.

It translates the Church Manual's expectations into practical workflows, routines, templates, and checklists so that a newly elected or appointed Clerk can step into the role with clarity.

This document answers five practical questions:

1. What is the Church Clerk responsible for?
 2. What must the Clerk do regularly?
 3. What must the Clerk do when specific events occur?
 4. What records, reports, and communications must the Clerk maintain?
 5. How should the Clerk work with the pastor, church board, conference, and members?
-

2. Manual Alignment Principle

This playbook is governed by three rules:

1. No responsibility should be assigned to the Clerk unless it is grounded in the Church Manual.
2. All Clerk duties must map to the Manual's logic on membership, records, meetings, elections, reports, and church governance.
3. Where this document proposes templates, registers, or calendars, these are operating tools designed to help the Clerk faithfully execute Manual-based responsibilities. They are not new sources of authority.

In this document:

- **Manual requirement** means the duty is directly stated or clearly required by the Church Manual.
- **Operating tool** means a practical template, checklist, or rhythm that helps execute a Manual requirement.

- **Local adaptation** means the church may adjust the format without changing the Manual's requirements.
-

3. The Office of the Church Clerk

3.1 Why the Office Matters

Much of the efficient functioning of the church depends on the work of the Clerk. Because the office has important and specialized functions, continuity in record keeping and reporting matters.

The Clerk safeguards the church's official memory. The role protects the integrity of membership records, preserves official actions, supports orderly governance, and helps the church remain accountable to the conference and to its own decisions.

3.2 Core Identity of the Role

The Church Clerk is:

- Custodian of church records
- Secretary for church business meetings
- Secretary or recording officer for the church board, where that responsibility is assigned locally
- Membership records administrator
- Reporting link between the local church and the conference
- Administrative support to church governance processes
- A key support officer in redemptive membership review and membership accountability

3.3 Operating Posture of the Role

The Clerk's work must be marked by:

- Accuracy
 - Confidentiality
 - Timeliness
 - Orderliness
 - Faithfulness to church action
 - Respect for church process
 - Pastoral sensitivity when handling records that affect real members
-

4. Guiding Principles

4.1 No Membership Action Without Proper Authority

The Clerk has no authority to add names to or remove names from the membership record without a vote of the church, except where the Church Manual provides a specific exception, such as death or a member's written request to be removed.

The Clerk records authorized action; the Clerk does not create authority for action.

4.2 Church Records Must Be Accurate and Current

The membership record must be accurately and currently maintained in order to show the official standing of the membership.

This means records must be:

- Current
- Chronological
- Supported by documentation
- Consistent with official church action

4.3 Minutes and Actions Must Be Properly Recorded

Minutes should record the time and date of meetings, number attending, and all actions taken.

The Clerk's goal is not to record every word spoken, but to preserve the official actions of the church or board clearly enough that future leaders can know what was decided, when, and by whom.

4.4 Reports Must Be Furnished Promptly

The Clerk must promptly furnish reports requested by the conference.

Reports are not merely local paperwork. They contribute to the accuracy of the broader reporting system of the Church.

4.5 Church Records Belong to the Church

Church records are the property of the church. They are to be surrendered to the newly elected Clerk at the expiration of the previous Clerk's term, or to the church during the term if requested by the pastor or elders.

4.6 Confidentiality Matters

The Clerk handles sensitive information relating to membership standing, transfers, removals, deaths, member correspondence, conference reports, and official actions.

Confidentiality is not optional. It is part of preserving trust, fairness, and orderly church governance.

5. Formal Responsibilities of the Church Clerk

The Clerk's responsibilities fall into six major areas:

1. Membership administration
2. Governance and meetings
3. Records management
4. Reporting
5. Correspondence and notifications
6. Support for redemptive membership review and accountability

Each area is described below.

6. Membership Administration

6.1 Maintaining the Membership Record

Manual basis: The church must have one current, regularly updated membership record. Names are added or removed only by church vote, at death, or at the member's request.

The Clerk ensures that:

- Every member's status is properly recorded
- Additions and removals are supported by proper authority
- Dates and methods of receiving or removing members are entered accurately
- The membership record remains current and usable for governance and pastoral care
- Supporting documentation is filed and traceable

6.2 Membership Actions the Clerk Must Track

The Clerk must maintain records relating to:

- Baptismal additions
- Profession of faith
- Transfer in
- Transfer out
- Death
- Written request for removal

- Removal by church action
- Readmission by church action
- Rebaptism where applicable
- Adjustment in or adjustment out where duplicate or missing records are identified and the church votes accordingly

6.3 Transfers of Membership

Manual basis: The Clerk handles correspondence between members and churches in the transferring of memberships. The board may recommend, but the church takes action on transfers.

Workflow: Transfer Out

1. Receive request or notice that a member desires transfer.
2. Confirm the receiving church and contact details.
3. Prepare or process the required transfer correspondence.
4. Bring the matter through the proper church process.
5. Record the church action once voted.
6. Update the membership register only when the transfer is complete.
7. File all transfer correspondence.

Workflow: Transfer In

1. Receive transfer communication from the former church.
2. Confirm the member's details.
3. Route the matter through the appropriate church process.
4. Record the vote or final action.
5. Enter the member in the official record.
6. File documentation.

6.4 Removals From Membership

The Clerk must be especially careful in matters involving removal from membership.

The Clerk does not remove names by personal judgment. The Clerk records the action of the church.

Exceptions requiring direct record action by the Clerk are limited to:

- Death of a member
- A member's written request to be removed from membership, handled according to the Manual's process

Even in these cases, the Clerk records the appropriate action and files supporting facts.

6.5 Death of a Member

When a member dies, the Clerk records the date of death in the membership record.

Recommended file items:

- Name of member
- Date of death
- Source confirming death
- Date recorded in membership register

6.6 Written Request for Removal

When a member submits a written request to be removed from membership, the request is handled according to the Church Manual.

The Clerk should file:

- Member's written request
- Date received
- Board action reference, where applicable
- Date recorded in the membership register

6.7 Members Designated as Missing

Where members remain missing after every effort has been made to locate and welcome them back into fellowship, the church may certify that it has tried without success to locate them, and the members may be removed by vote of the church.

The Clerk records the action in the membership record using the Manual's language:

"Location unknown. Voted to designate as missing."

7. Records Management

7.1 Church Record Book and Record Systems

The church record book contains space for recording membership, including how and when members are received or removed.

The record must be:

- Chronological
- Accurate
- Supported by data
- Connected to the minutes where membership actions are recorded

If the church uses an electronic system, the same standards apply.

7.2 Records the Clerk Must Maintain

At minimum, the Clerk should maintain:

- Official membership register
- Church board minutes
- Business meeting minutes
- Membership action log
- Transfer correspondence files
- Delegate records for conference sessions
- Conference reporting log
- Committee appointment records where applicable
- Handover file
- Historical resolutions and major governance actions

7.3 Committee Lists and Terms of Reference

Where committees are appointed at a meeting, the Clerk should make a list of committees appointed and provide each chairperson with:

- Committee name
- Chairperson
- Members
- Date appointed
- Terms of reference
- Outline of work assigned
- Reporting expectation or deadline, where given

This is not a new authority. It is a record-keeping duty flowing from the Manual's requirement that the Clerk record and preserve committee appointments and actions.

7.4 Retention and Handover

At the close of a term, the Clerk must ensure that records are ready to be handed over.

Handover Package Checklist

- Membership register
- Minute books or electronic minutes files
- Business meeting records
- Board meeting records
- Conference correspondence and reporting files

- Delegate records
 - Committee appointment records
 - Pending action list
 - Open transfer list
 - Archive index
 - Access credentials for approved systems, transferred according to local policy
 - Calendar of pending deadlines
-

8. Governance and Meetings

8.1 The Clerk as Secretary in Meetings

When the Clerk, as secretary, cannot attend a business meeting, the Clerk should arrange for an assistant to be present to take the minutes.

This means the Clerk must treat meeting records as a core responsibility, not an optional clerical task.

8.2 Meetings the Clerk Should Expect to Support

Depending on local church structure and practice, the Clerk may support:

- Church business meetings
- Church board meetings
- Membership review meetings
- Delegate-related meetings
- Election process meetings where official record support is required
- Committee reporting processes where actions must be preserved

8.3 Business Meetings

Business meetings should be held at least once a year.

The business meeting has authority over the board and may delegate responsibilities to the board in addition to those already assigned by the Church Manual.

At least once each year, reports about the work of the church should be included on the agenda. Based on those reports, a proposed plan of action for the next year, including an annual budget, should be presented for approval.

Clerk's Role Before the Business Meeting

- Confirm date, time, and place with the pastor or chairperson
- Prepare previous minutes for confirmation
- Prepare attendance register or attendance method

- Prepare agenda support materials
- Gather documents that must be formally received
- Prepare membership items requiring church action
- Prepare committee appointment records if committees are to be appointed

Clerk's Role During the Business Meeting

- Record date, time, place, and chairperson
- Record attendance or number present
- Record motions, recommendations, and actions clearly
- Record membership actions exactly as voted
- Record reports received and action taken
- Record committee appointments and assigned work
- Record elections, appointments, and resolutions

Clerk's Role After the Business Meeting

- Draft minutes promptly
- Review for accuracy
- File approved minutes
- Update records affected by church action
- Communicate action items to relevant officers where authorized
- Update committee registers, officer lists, and membership records as applicable

Business Meeting Minutes Template

Local Church Business Meeting Minutes

- Church:
- Date:
- Time:
- Venue:
- Chairperson:
- Clerk / Recording Secretary:
- Attendance / Number present:
- Opening prayer:

Agenda Items 1. Confirmation of previous minutes 2. Matters arising 3. Reports received 4. Membership actions 5. Financial matters 6. Committee matters 7. Elections / appointments 8. Resolutions 9. Plan of action 10. Closing prayer

Detailed Actions Taken

- Motion / Recommendation:
- Moved by:

- Seconded by:
- Outcome:
- Follow-up action:
- Responsible person:
- Deadline:

8.4 Church Board Meetings

The board is the chief committee of the church. The Clerk often functions as secretary of the board.

Clerk's Role in the Church Board

- Prepare and preserve minutes
- Record membership-related recommendations and actions
- Track committee appointments and reports
- Preserve resolutions and assigned actions
- Maintain continuity between meetings
- Ensure board records remain accurate and accessible to authorized church leadership

Monthly Board Support Checklist

Before the Meeting

- Confirm date and agenda with chairperson / pastor
- Review unfinished business from prior meeting
- Gather reports expected for the meeting
- Prepare membership action items
- Prepare committee report tracker
- Prepare attendance list

During the Meeting

- Record meeting details
- Capture decisions and recommendations
- Capture reports received
- Record membership items carefully
- Record committee assignments and deadlines

After the Meeting

- Draft minutes promptly
- Confirm accuracy of actions
- File minutes securely

- Update action tracker
- Update membership records only where proper authority exists
- Send authorized extracts or notices to responsible persons

Board Minutes Template

Local Church Board Meeting Minutes

- Church:
- Date:
- Time:
- Venue:
- Chairperson:
- Secretary / Clerk:
- Number present:
- Apologies:
- Opening prayer:

Agenda 1. Devotional / opening 2. Confirmation of previous minutes 3. Matters arising 4. Membership matters 5. Reports from departments / committees 6. Financial matters 7. Governance matters 8. Upcoming plans 9. Resolutions and assignments 10. Closing prayer

Action Register

- Action:
- Assigned to:
- Due date:
- Status:

8.5 Elections and Nominating Committee Process Support

The Clerk may provide administrative support to election processes.

Relevant Manual logic:

- Officers are elected every one or two years through an appointed nominating committee.
- In exceptional circumstances, and in consultation with the conference, the term of office may be extended an additional year.
- The nominating committee prepares the list of officers.
- The church votes on the names presented.

Clerk's Role in Election-Related Processes

- Preserve official minutes of election actions

- Record the church's vote accurately
- Update officer records after election
- Prepare transition and handover records where needed
- Support delegate credential documentation where relevant

The Clerk should not treat election support as authority to influence or manage the nominating committee's decisions.

9. Reporting Responsibilities

9.1 Reports to Be Furnished Promptly

The Clerk must promptly furnish reports requested by the conference.

Some reports may be quarterly, others annual. The Clerk collects information for these reports from other officers and department leaders where needed.

9.2 Types of Reports the Clerk May Prepare or Coordinate

- Quarterly membership reports
- Annual statistical reports
- Delegate notifications and credential details
- Membership movement summaries
- Reports requested by the conference secretary
- Internal board updates where needed to keep records current

9.3 Monthly Clerk Report to the Church Board

A monthly Clerk report is an operating tool, not a separate Church Manual requirement. It helps the board remain informed and helps the Clerk keep records current.

Purpose

To keep the board informed on:

- Membership records
- Membership actions pending and completed
- Reporting deadlines met or upcoming
- Correspondence handled
- Record integrity issues needing attention
- Membership review and reclaiming support

Monthly Church Clerk Report Template

- Church:

- Reporting month:
- Clerk:
- Date submitted:

1. Membership Summary

- Current official membership:
- Additions this month:
- Transfers in:
- Transfers out:
- Deaths recorded:
- Removal requests received:
- Readmissions:
- Pending membership actions:

2. Records and Documentation

- Board minutes updated: Yes / No
- Business meeting records updated: Yes / No
- Membership register updated: Yes / No
- Outstanding documentation issues:

3. Correspondence Handled

- Transfer letters sent:
- Transfer letters received:
- Conference correspondence sent:
- Conference correspondence received:
- Member follow-up correspondence:

4. Reporting Status

- Reports submitted this month:
- Reports due next month:
- Delayed items requiring attention:

5. Membership Review / Reclaiming Support

- Classification work updated: Yes / No
- Names referred for follow-up:
- Progress since last report:

6. Matters Requiring Board Action

- Item 1:
- Item 2:
- Item 3:

9.4 Quarterly Conference Report Checklist

- Membership totals verified against register
- Additions and removals matched to authorized minutes
- Transfers reconciled
- Report completed using official format
- Submitted before deadline
- Copy archived locally

9.5 Annual Clerk Report

At the end of the year, the Clerk should prepare a consolidated report for the business meeting or for handover to incoming leadership.

Suggested contents:

- Opening membership figure
- Closing membership figure
- Total additions
- Total removals
- Transfers in / out
- Deaths recorded
- Major governance actions recorded
- Reports submitted to conference
- Status of record accuracy and archive condition
- Key issues requiring action in the next year

10. Correspondence and Notifications

10.1 Corresponding With Members

The Clerk should try to keep in touch with absent members.

The Clerk should correspond frequently with absent members and pass on news of church progress, encouraging them to report their Christian activities each quarter.

Workflow for Absent Member Correspondence

1. Identify absent member through records, pastoral input, or membership review.
2. Confirm contact details.

3. Send respectful communication with church updates and encouragement.
4. Record date and type of contact.
5. Refer pastoral concerns to the pastor or elders where needed.
6. Track whether the member responds.

Absent Member Contact Log

Name	Contact Info	Date Contacted	Method	Summary	Follow-up Needed	Assigned To
------	--------------	----------------	--------	---------	------------------	-------------

10.2 Notice of Delegates for Conference Sessions

On authorization of the board, the Clerk promptly notifies the conference of delegates elected to represent the church at a conference session, using the forms provided by the conference.

Delegate Notification Workflow

1. Record church action electing delegates.
2. Obtain official forms from the conference.
3. Complete delegate credential information accurately.
4. Submit within deadline.
5. File copies of submitted forms.
6. Confirm receipt where possible.

Delegate Submission Tracker

Delegate Name	Date Elected	Form Completed	Date Submitted	Confirmation
---------------	--------------	----------------	----------------	--------------

10.3 Official Committee and Meeting Notices

Where the church's local practice assigns notice support to the Clerk, the Clerk may help issue or track notice for:

- Board meetings
- Business meetings
- Specially called meetings
- Delegate-related actions
- Committee appointment notices

This is a local operating support function, not independent authority to call meetings.

11. Redemptive Membership Review and Membership Accountability

Redemptive membership review is grounded in accurate membership records and aims at pastoral care, reclaiming, and discipleship.

The Clerk's role is crucial because the process depends on accurate membership lists and properly updated records.

11.1 Manual Purpose of Redemptive Membership Review

The review intends to improve pastoral care based on accurate membership records. It must have a redemptive purpose of seeing people rather than numbers.

11.2 Clerk's Role in the Process

The Clerk will:

- Provide an updated membership list
- Participate in preparing classification lists where assigned
- Help track progress by category
- Update records after reports and authorized actions
- Prepare or support board reports on membership review progress

11.3 Suggested Classification Categories

Based on the Church Manual notes, categories may include:

- Frequently attending members
- Non-frequently attending members
- Members attending another Seventh-day Adventist church
- Location unknown
- Members to reclaim

11.4 Workflow: Quarterly Membership Review Support

Before the Review

- Generate current membership list
- Prepare classification worksheet
- Gather known updates from elders or leaders
- Prepare previous progress summary

During the Review

- Record agreed classifications
- Record category action items
- Track names needing pastoral or elder follow-up

After the Review

- Update classification records

- Prepare summary for board
- Prepare outreach or reclaiming lists where assigned
- Track movement between categories

11.5 Quarterly Membership Review Report Template

- Church:
- Quarter:
- Clerk:
- Date:

1. Total Official Membership

2. Classification Summary

- Frequently attending members:
- Non-frequently attending members:
- Members attending another SDA church:
- Location unknown:
- Members assigned for reclaiming:

3. Movement Since Last Quarter

- Moved into active attendance:
- Located after being unknown:
- Referred for transfer:
- Referred for reclaiming visit:

4. Key Actions Taken

- Home visits:
- Calls / correspondence:
- Names assigned to elders / ministries:

5. Matters Requiring Board Attention

- Item 1:
- Item 2:
- Item 3:

6. Next Quarter Priorities

12. Committees and the Clerk's Role in Them

12.1 Church Board

Status: The Clerk ordinarily serves as secretary or recording officer where assigned locally.

Clerk's role:

- Record minutes
- Present prior minutes
- Preserve official board actions
- Track committee appointments and terms of reference
- Record membership-related recommendations and actions carefully
- Provide records needed for continuity between meetings

12.2 Church Business Meeting

Status: The Clerk serves as secretary / recording officer of the church's formal business proceedings.

Clerk's role:

- Record proceedings
- Preserve actions and resolutions
- Track committee appointments
- Maintain the institutional record of the meeting

12.3 Special Revision / Membership Review Committee

Status: The Clerk is a key support officer where such a committee or process exists.

Clerk's role:

- Provide updated membership lists
- Help prepare classification lists where assigned
- Record progress by category
- Update records after review outcomes and authorized actions

12.4 Nominating / Election-Related Processes

Status: The Clerk is not automatically a decision-maker in the nominating process, but may support election documentation once church action is involved.

Clerk's role:

- Record election outcomes
- Maintain officer lists

- Support documentation of approved nominees and delegates
- Preserve minutes and election records

12.5 Delegate Processes for Conference Sessions

Status: The Clerk is the administrative channel for formal delegate notification to the conference after proper church action.

Clerk's role:

- Record elected delegates
 - Complete official forms
 - Notify the conference
 - Preserve copies and confirmation
-

13. Monthly, Quarterly, and Annual Rhythm of Work

13.1 Monthly Clerk Rhythm

Every month, the Clerk should normally:

- Update membership records for completed, authorized actions
- Prepare for church board meeting
- Present or submit monthly Clerk update, where used locally
- Review pending transfer correspondence
- Review conference deadlines
- Follow up on absent-member correspondence where appropriate
- Update action tracker from previous meeting
- Organize minutes and documentation from the month

13.2 Quarterly Clerk Rhythm

Every quarter, the Clerk should normally:

- Complete or support membership classification review
- Submit required quarterly conference reports
- Encourage or track correspondence with absent members
- Review archive completeness
- Reconcile official records with recent church actions

13.3 Annual Clerk Rhythm

Every year, the Clerk should normally:

- Support at least one business meeting
 - Prepare annual summary report
 - Review membership records for integrity
 - Support delegate processes if conference session timing requires it
 - Prepare handover materials if elections are due
 - Review annual reporting obligations to conference
-

14. Detailed Standard Operating Procedures

SOP 1: Recording Minutes

Trigger: A formal church meeting takes place.

Authority Check: Meeting has been properly called and chaired.

Steps: 1. Prepare prior minutes and agenda support materials. 2. Attend with minute book or approved recording system. 3. Record date, place, time, chairperson, attendance, and actions. 4. Record motions and decisions clearly. 5. Record membership actions exactly as voted. 6. Record committee appointments and terms of reference where applicable. 7. Draft minutes promptly after the meeting. 8. File approved minutes chronologically. 9. Update related logs and trackers.

Output: Approved and archived minutes.

SOP 2: Processing Membership Addition

Trigger: A person is received into membership by baptism, profession of faith, transfer, or other Manual-approved method.

Authority Check: Church action or Manual-approved basis exists.

Steps: 1. Gather supporting details. 2. Confirm church action or official basis for receipt. 3. Record method and date of reception. 4. Enter member into official register. 5. File supporting documentation. 6. Reflect change in next applicable report.

Output: Updated membership record.

SOP 3: Processing Membership Removal

Trigger: A member is removed through proper church action or a Manual-approved exception.

Authority Check: Church vote exists, or death/written request exception applies.

Steps: 1. Confirm basis for removal. 2. Confirm church action where required. 3. Record method and date of removal. 4. Update membership register. 5. File supporting records. 6. Reflect change in reporting.

Output: Updated membership record.

SOP 4: Processing Membership Transfer

Trigger: Transfer request or transfer correspondence is received.

Authority Check: Process follows the Manual's membership transfer procedure.

Steps: 1. Log request. 2. Verify sending or receiving church. 3. Prepare or process correspondence. 4. Route through church action where required. 5. Update membership record only when transfer is complete. 6. File correspondence.

Output: Completed transfer file.

SOP 5: Preparing Conference Report

Trigger: Conference reporting deadline approaches.

Authority Check: Data must match official church records.

Steps: 1. Review reporting deadline and requirements. 2. Gather data from register and relevant officers. 3. Verify accuracy. 4. Complete official form. 5. Submit on time. 6. File a copy. 7. Record submission date.

Output: Submitted and archived report.

SOP 6: Supporting Redemptive Membership Review

Trigger: Quarterly or locally scheduled review cycle.

Authority Check: Review is conducted for pastoral care and record accuracy, not arbitrary removal.

Steps: 1. Generate updated membership list. 2. Prepare classification worksheet. 3. Attend or support review process. 4. Record category decisions. 5. Update classification records. 6. Prepare report to board. 7. Track progress before next review.

Output: Updated classification records and review report.

SOP 7: Handover at End of Term

Trigger: New Clerk elected or current Clerk leaving office.

Authority Check: Records belong to the church and must be surrendered.

Steps: 1. Reconcile registers and files. 2. Organize minute books and digital files. 3. Prepare pending matters list. 4. Prepare handover inventory. 5. Transfer records formally. 6. Brief incoming Clerk. 7. Confirm church retains access to all official records.

Output: Complete handover pack.

15. Templates and Registers

15.1 Membership Action Log

Date	Name	Action Type	Basis / Vote	Effective Date	Recorded By	Notes
------	------	-------------	--------------	----------------	-------------	-------

15.2 Transfer Tracker

Name	Direction	Date Initiated	Other Church	Confirmation Received	Date Closed
------	-----------	----------------	--------------	-----------------------	-------------

15.3 Absent Member Contact Log

Name	Contact Info	Date Contacted	Method	Summary	Follow-up Needed	Assigned To
------	--------------	----------------	--------	---------	------------------	-------------

15.4 Committee Appointment Register

Committee	Chairperson	Members	Date Appointed	Terms of Reference	Reporting Deadline
-----------	-------------	---------	----------------	--------------------	--------------------

15.5 Conference Reporting Register

Report Name	Period Covered	Deadline	Date Submitted	Submitted To	Confirmation Received
-------------	----------------	----------	----------------	--------------	-----------------------

15.6 Clerk Handover Checklist

- Membership register updated
- All minutes filed
- Pending actions listed
- Conference reports filed
- Transfer correspondence filed
- Delegate records filed
- Committee appointment records filed
- Archive index prepared
- Approved system access transferred appropriately
- Incoming Clerk briefed

16. First 90 Days for a New Church Clerk

Days 1–30

- Receive all official records

- Understand current membership register
- Review previous year's minutes
- Review conference reporting calendar
- Meet pastor and first elder
- Understand current committee and governance structure
- Identify pending membership actions
- Set up filing system and trackers

Days 31–60

- Attend and record meetings confidently
- Reconcile key membership records
- Begin regular Clerk reporting where used locally
- Establish absent-member correspondence process
- Review transfer backlog
- Understand business meeting cycle

Days 61–90

- Support quarterly membership review
- Confirm archive orderliness
- Confirm current reports are up to date
- Prepare improvement recommendations for record accuracy and workflow discipline

17. What Good Performance Looks Like

A strong Church Clerk:

- Maintains an accurate and current membership register
 - Produces timely and reliable minutes
 - Meets conference reporting deadlines
 - Preserves records securely and in order
 - Supports membership accountability faithfully
 - Helps the church govern itself with clarity and continuity
 - Is trusted for discretion, diligence, and steadiness
-

18. Risks if the Clerk Function Is Weak

If the Clerk's work is weak, the church may experience:

- Inaccurate membership records
 - Missing or disputed decisions
 - Delayed conference reporting
 - Poor handovers between office holders
 - Weak accountability for church actions
 - Confusion in elections and delegate processes
 - Reduced ability to reclaim absent members effectively
-

19. Suggested Appendices to Add Later

1. Sample completed board minutes
 2. Sample completed business meeting minutes
 3. Sample monthly Clerk report
 4. Sample quarterly membership review report
 5. Sample transfer letter templates
 6. Annual Clerk calendar
 7. Handover inventory form
 8. Filing structure guide for paper and digital records
-

20. Closing Note

The office of the Church Clerk is not merely clerical. It is a ministry of order, memory, accountability, and faithfulness.

Through careful records, timely reports, disciplined correspondence, and support for redemptive membership oversight, the Clerk helps the church function with integrity and continuity.

This playbook should be reviewed and adapted to the local church's actual governance rhythms, provided that all adaptations remain in harmony with the Church Manual and the requirements of the local conference.